

Mikel *Rosenthal*

DESIGNER · VISUAL CRAFT · BRAND & CAMPAIGN · DESIGN SYSTEMS · GENERATIVE AI PRACTICE

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I. SUMMARY

A designer obsessed with visual craft, 23 years making complex work beautiful: typography, spacing, color, motion, and the interaction details most teams never get to. Deep history in regulated healthcare and enterprise products, as a core contributor to **GE Healthcare's** Edison Design System (2020 Red Dot for Interface Design) and the builder of **Blue Cross Blue Shield's** FIBER system. Five design systems built, plus contributions inside mature systems at GE and Verizon, carried today as fluency rather than specialty: comfortable in any system, focused on making the work inside it exceptional. Accessibility built in by default. Alongside that, most of my discretionary time now goes to generative AI and what it changes about how creative gets made, with the same rigor I bring to a type scale. Principal Designer at **PBK Studio**. *Complex work, made beautiful, built to scale.*

II. GENERATIVE AI PRACTICE

Hands-on, and honest about the map *production work, not demos*

Adobe Firefly and Photoshop generative fill and expand in production for image extension, reframing across placements, and cleanup, chosen partly because it is the model with a commercial indemnification path. ChatGPT and Claude daily for concepting, naming, copy iteration, and image work. Figma Make for taking a direction to a clickable prototype in an afternoon. Still in discovery on Midjourney, Runway, and Veo, running the same brief through each and scoring on brand fidelity, control across a set, edit-ability, cost per usable asset, and rights posture. I would rather show a team an honest comparison than overstate a tool I have used twice.

Method, written down *the systems habit, applied*

Authored a generative AI creative standard for regulated categories: layered prompt architecture, house style blocks, a negative-prompt library written against implied-claim and synthetic-clinician risk, seed and reference control for set consistency, naming and versioning, model rights posture, a review packet for legal, and metrics for whether any of it is working. Built because prompt lists go stale in a month and the layer underneath them does not.

III. EXPERIENCE

PBK Studio *Principal Designer*

MAY 2026 – PRESENT

DESIGN SYSTEMS · PRODUCT · BRAND · WEB · MOTION · VOICE · DESIGN ENGINEERING

Independent multidisciplinary studio designing composable design systems, AI-augmented product experiences, generative brand identity, and original music and voice work for enterprise and consumer clients.

- Engagements span enterprise design systems (healthcare, fintech, insurance), real estate microsites, brand identity, and responsive web.
- Deliverables ship with governance, accessibility, and developer handoff built in, Figma-first, with clear documentation and contribution patterns.
- Design and build in one pass with Claude Code and Codex: working prototypes and production front-end, plus agent runs for variants, audits, and documentation. MikelRosenthal.com and a daily intel dashboard were built this way.
- Original music released as PitchBlackKnight; SAG-eligible voice performance for commercial, narrative, and sonic branding.

Verizon *Senior Design System Designer II*

DEC 2025

SHORT-TERM CONTRACT VIA INSIGHT GLOBAL · REMOTE

Scoped engagement on the post-rebrand enterprise design system. Delivered the calendar component with full states, tokens, variables, and accessibility. A month of scope, shipped in the first week.

The Bettering Company *Brand Designer*

MAY 2024 – AUG 2025

FREELANCE · REMOTE / CHICAGO, IL

Built a new brand identity and lightweight design system, translating the company's core values into a cohesive visual language and shipping-ready guidelines.

- Generated and refined a wide range of logo concepts, exploring form, symbolism, and narrative to capture the brand's mission.
- Established brand guidelines and flexible foundations for consistent application across digital and physical touchpoints.

Avant *Senior Product, UI/UX & Design Systems*

MAY 2021 – AUG 2024

FULL-TIME · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Led design and development of Avant's Pathfinder Design System and a marketing design library spanning product and brand.

- Defined the visual language and component architecture that kept multi-platform work consistent.
- Designed dense, data-heavy advisor tooling in a dark-themed product UI; partnered with engineering on reusable Figma libraries and themeable variants.
- Introduced a brand and marketing design library, with campaign templates and paid social kits, that streamlined consistency for 350+ marketers.
- Art-directed output across paid social, email, display, web, and event, holding one voice across every surface and size.

GE Healthcare *Senior UX/UI Product Designer, Design Systems*

JAN 2020 – FEB 2021

CONTRACT · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Core contributor to the award-winning Edison Design System, designing and evangelizing modules as part of the team behind a foundation unifying 40+ regulated clinical and enterprise healthcare products.

- Developed scalable Figma component libraries and UX documentation adopted across diverse clinical product teams and device surfaces.
- Central role in winning the 2020 Red Dot Award, Fast Company Innovation by Design, and the dmi:DVA Award for Interface Design.
- Partnered with accessibility and compliance teams to ensure usability across regulated healthcare environments.

SurePeople *Lead UX/UI Visual Product Designer*

JUN 2020 – SEP 2020

CONTRACT · REMOTE / CHICAGO, IL

Led UX and visual design of the PRISM psychometric platform, translating complex behavioral data into clear, human-readable visualization.

- Defined interaction models, visual hierarchy, and IA for complex data visualization; built the platform's modular UI system from scratch in Figma.

Blue Cross Blue Shield *Senior Product / Design Systems Designer*

MAY 2018 – DEC 2019

CONTRACT · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Created and maintained the FIBER Design System, a coded, production-ready framework that accelerated product-to-market timelines.

- Defined typography, color, grids, and iconography; partnered with engineering on themeable, documented components.
- Partnered with engineering on design-to-code handoff; mentored teams in accessibility and documentation standards.

TransUnion *Senior UX Designer, Design Systems*

MAY 2018 – JUN 2019

CONTRACT · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Designed the global TUCM Design System and visual identity for customer-facing and internal applications, building responsive, scalable UI libraries and universal style guidelines.

Maven Wave / Eviden *UX Team Senior Lead, Design Systems*

JAN 2013 – MAY 2018

FULL-TIME · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Directed conceptual and visual direction across Fortune 500 client projects, integrating UX principles with brand storytelling.

- Established scalable design workflows and early design-system patterns for clients including Google, AT&T, and Nike.
- Created prototypes, journey maps, and digital ecosystems across app, web, and co-branded products; mentored design teams.

Biersma Creative (merged into Maven Wave) *Senior Designer & UX Lead*

JAN 2006 – JAN 2013

FULL-TIME · CHICAGO, IL

Led visual brand and UX direction across healthcare, retail, and entertainment for clients including Aflac, AbbVie, Crate & Barrel, Disney, Google, Nike, Herman Miller, and Salesforce. Pharma and payer work ran through medical, legal, and regulatory review.

Firebelly Design *Junior Graphic Designer*

JAN 2003 – JAN 2005

FULL-TIME · CHICAGO, IL

Concept-to-execution brand and web design; print and digital for ComEd, Petco, Harris Bank, and Scholastic.

IV. SKILLS

UI & Visual Design Craft · Typography · Layout & Composition · Color · Illustration Direction · Retouching & Compositing · **Brand & Campaign** Brand Identity · Packaging · Paid Social & Performance Creative · Email & Display · Art Direction · **Design Systems** (five built · contributor at GE & Verizon) · Interaction & Motion Design · Micro-Interactions · **Cross-Platform** Native Mobile UI (Apple HIG · Material Design) · iOS · Android · Web · High-Fidelity Prototyping (Figma · HTML/CSS) · Complex Data Visualization · Regulated Healthcare & Enterprise UI · Accessibility (WCAG 2.2) · **Generative AI** Adobe Firefly · Photoshop generative fill & expand · ChatGPT & Claude · Figma Make · Claude Code · Codex · Prompt architecture · Negative-prompt libraries for regulated categories · Tool evaluation & scorecards · Asset rights & governance · **Tools** Figma · Adobe Creative Suite

V. AWARDS & EDUCATION

2020 Red Dot Award · Interface Design

EDISON DESIGN SYSTEM · GE HEALTHCARE

2020 Fast Company · Innovation by Design

2020 dmi:DVA · Design Value Award

MSU Film Festival · 1st, Published Works

Missouri State University · Springfield, MO

BFA, SUMMA CUM LAUDE · ELECTRONIC ARTS & DESIGN

MINOR: MASS MEDIA & COMMUNICATIONS

Generative Motion Archive

156 WORKS · PITCHBLACKKNIGHT.COM